```
ssh [USER]@[IP] [command or script]
```

Let us look at how this can be done. Suppose you want to display the directory contents of */root* of a remote host, you can run the following command:

```
[narendra@ubunu]$ ssh root@172.16.223.128 ls -l /root
root@172.16.223.128's password:
total 12

drwxr-xr-x. 2 root root 4096 Mar 12 00:05 device_drivers

drwxr-xr-x. 2 root root 4096 Mar 12 01:31 pthreads

drwxr-xr-x. 2 root root 4096 Mar 12 01:32 python

[narendra@ubunu]$
```

The same can be done to run any script on the remote computer.

—Narendra Kangralkar,
narendrakangralkar@gmail.com

Run a Linux command after every reboot

This tip allows you to run any Linux command or script just after system reboot. You can use the *@reboot cron* keyword.

If you have a script in your */home* directory and it needs to be run on every boot, open the *cron* file in editable mode and add the following:

```
$crontab -e

@reboot /home/xyz/myscript.sh
```

Do remember to enable *crond* on boot.

—Imran Sheikh,
imrannsheikh@gmail.com

Comment out hashes in large configuration files

Here is a small tip for systems administrators, who need to tackle large configuration files, which include lots of commented lines (marked by #). With this tip, you can remove all those hashes and provide only an uncommented configuration view for faster lookup into the file.

If you want to check the configuration file of the Squid proxy server, run the following command:

```
#cat squid.conf | egrep -v ^#
```

This will show only lines that do not start with a hash mark, thus giving the configuration parameter that is being used in the current set-up.

—Yogesh Upadhyay,
yogeshupadhya@gmail.com

Replacing '\n' with 'space' in each line of a file

You can use the *awk* statement given below to remove the '*\n*' from each line and replace it with a blank space:

```
awk '$1=$1' ORS=' ' /etc/passwd
```

—Rajeev N Sambhu,
rajnellaya@gmail.com

Know your shells

Here is a command that will let you know about the available shells on your Linux distribution:

```
#chsh -l
```

To change your login shell, use the following command:

```
# chsh
```

—Chandralekha Balachandran,
reachlekha@gmail.com

Advanced *ls* commands

The following commands are very useful to know your system better.

lspci – Lists all PCI devices. Use -v for verbose output.

lsusb – Lists all USB devices. Use -v for verbose output.

lsmod – Lists the status of modules in the Linux kernel.

lsattr – Lists file attributes on a second extended Linux file system.

lsof – Lists the file descriptors opened by all the processes. A very useful command when a process fails to close any file descriptors.

To know more details, you can view the manual pages of each command mentioned above.

—Prasanna Mohanasundaram,
prasanna.mohanasundaram@gmail.com

END

Share Your Linux Recipes!

The joy of using Linux is in finding ways to get around problems—take them head on, defeat them! We invite you to share your tips and tricks with us for publication in *OSFY* so that they can reach a wider audience. Your tips could be related to administration, programming, troubleshooting or general tweaking. Submit them at *www.linuxforu.com*. The sender of each published tip will get a T-shirt.